



Japan has world's fastest internet

Japan breaks world record for fastest internet speed, 319 terabits per second.
<https://digit.in/oct21-19>



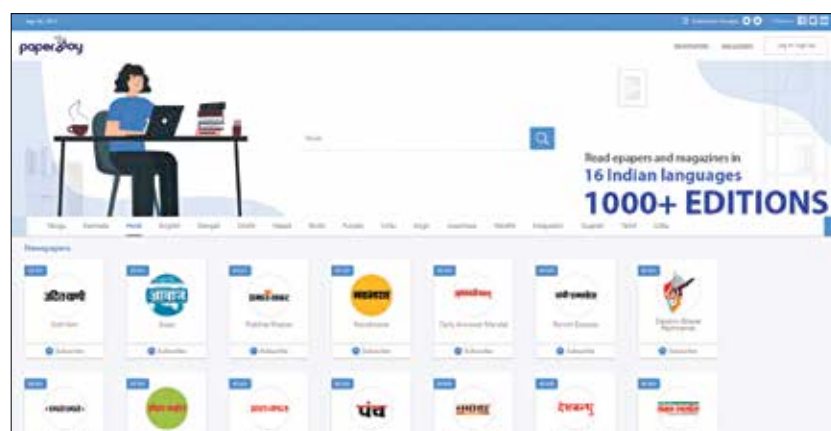
Apple's animation issues

Apple says issue prevents some animations from using high refresh rates on the iPhone 13 Pros. <https://digit.in/oct21-20>

we were cold calling them, and then they thought some random people were calling. We had to go out, we spoke to them in person, and convinced them.” As things turned out, it was easier to work with the regional language papers than the English newspapers, “one advantage we had with regional language newspapers, is that we could speak to them in their language and convince them. With the regional languages, we were able to onboard way more publishers.”

We then asked the exact process by which the newspapers are available so early in the morning, and how it gets digitised since the papers may not have their own versions available online. Karthik tells us, “these publications have a soft copy before they send it to print. We have created a dedicated server where the more tech savvy publications can directly upload the soft copies. Some smaller publications send us the soft copies by email. For the bigger publications, we just do an API call, which is simpler. With certain publications, the challenge is waiting for them to send an email, and I have a team to download and upload it accordingly. We have tried to automate the process, but to check again, we have a team working on it all night, and if the publication has not been sent, then we have to call and remind them to upload the paper. So there are a few bottlenecks here and there, but it is a part and parcel of the kind of app we are making.”

When asked about the development of the app itself and how much



of it is in house, Karthik tells us, “well, I would say about 50 percent of the technology is developed by us in house, and for the remaining 50 percent of the tech, we have partnered with this software company known as Hashtag. One major challenge was, for the publishers to send us the content, the files used to be 100-200 MB files, and we could not upload such large files, and we had to compress it without losing clarity. That was one challenge we faced initially, the reader experience in lower end smartphones. Initially when we launched, we tested on the devices we had and it seemed fine, but in reality a lot of crashes were happening, and we underestimated the lower level segment. That was the time Jio was picking up and lot of Vivos and Oppos were in the market, and smartphone adoption was blowing up. We underestimated that, and we had to go back to the drawing board to figure it out, compress the files more and make the interface

more fluid. That was a challenge, but we were able to overcome it, but still, it is an ongoing process.”

We asked about the teething problems for the app when it was just starting out. “One my family always supported me and all the things we have done. I had never thought about the challenges that would come my way, and I was given the freedom to fail. Even if we failed, there was nothing much to lose. I started when I was free in college, and would come back after college to work with my team. My team was a huge support, and were holding the fort when I wasn't there. We were able to divide the work properly and take things forward from there. A lot of random people in my college when they got to know that this was a startup, they were all like you know, ‘let me talk to this publisher’, or ‘my family knows this particular publication’, ‘I know someone in this paper’, so they were trying to pitch in, and ready to connect me to someone somewhere. In 2018 we won the tech aggregator of the year by the (Entrepreneur) Startup Award, which was a big award in IIT Delhi, and Akshay Kumar gave us that award. That was a huge thing, and the brand value also increased a lot. So that was real fun. Recently under the Atma Nirbhar App initiative, we came in number 3 as the best news app in India. That really gave us a push, and that allowed us to bag all the government deals that we were trying for. It gave us a good calling card.” **d**

